Inscription from Yakawlang sheds new light on history of Buddhism in Afghanistan, 2003).

Muslim writer Abu Abbas Al-Yaqoubi records in his book Kitāb al-buldān the destruction (AD 795) of a *Šāh Bahār* (Temple of the King). He mentions that the Arabs attacked the Šāh Bahār, “in which were idols worshipped by the people. They destroyed and burnt them.” (al-Baladhuri, 1924)

In AD 815, the Abbasid caliph Al-Ma’mun defeated the Kābul branch of the Turk Shahis. As per the Islamic traditional records, with hope of taking advantage of the Great Abbasid Civil War (AD 811-819), the Turk Shahi ruler, Pati Dumi had invaded the parts of Khorasan. The defeat left a large cultural clot on them as they had to convert to Islam apart from ceding their key cities and regions. Soon a campaign was led against the Gandhara branch of Shahis too. With the Caliphate reaching Indus River, a critical defeat reach to their baggage too. But the land won’t be Islamised yet and a new dynasty, the Hindu Shahi took over in Gandhara and Kābul in AD 822. The Zunbils would though remain unaffected by Al-Ma’mun’s raids and shall continue ruling for about two more decades, before the final conflict which shall script their extinction from the land of Sun God worshippers (Rehman, 2006). The Zunbils would be finally defeated in AD 870 AD by the Muslim conqueror and founder of Saffarid dynasty Yaqub bin Laith al-Saffar (AD 861–879). He conquered the entire Zunbil territory from his base in Sistan (Other).

By setting his march against the Kharijites of Herat, and defeating them in AD 870-71, Yaqub bin Laith al-Saffar began his conquests of east. Following which he marched towards Karukh and defeated Abd al-Rahman another *Khariji* leader (Bosworth, 1975). The campaign would intensify, and his army would then march to *Ghazna*, conquering the Zunbils, and further to Bamyan and Kābul, cornering the Hindu Shahis to the East. He kept conquering these territories in the name of Islam thereby appointing Muslim governors everywhere. After cornering the Hindu Shahis, the forces of Islam moved to north of the Hindu Kush and by 870 AD the whole of Khorasan was brought under Islamic Saffarid control. Having the Panjshir Valley under his control and here he would mint his Islamic silver coins (Bosworth, 1995).

According to C.E. Bosworth (author of Encyclopaedia of Islam), the Saffarids for the first time could bring Islamic expansion to the eastern Afghanistan after a bit more than two centuries of plundering raids done by the Muslim governors of Sistan that saw one of the fiercest resistances from the rulers of the region (Bosworth, 1975). This resistance was one of the most laudable in the Islamic experience.